Table 42. Bangladesh legal and policy instruments relevant to BAPIL (status, October 2026)

Instrument	Status	Relevance	Blueprint design response
Personal Data Protection Act, 2026	Act No. 63 of 2026, gazetted on 10 April 2026, replacing the Personal Data Protection Ordinance, 2025 [7, 8]. Deemed in force from 6 November 2025, except section 23 (chief data officers) and sections 31 to 35, which come into force by Gazette notification after 18 months [42]. Rules: to be confirmed	Consent as a clear affirmative indication, with other specified grounds (s. 5); data-subject rights including withdrawal from automated decisions (s. 13); enhanced protection of sensitive and children's data (s. 7); chief data officers (s. 23); data-residency provisions changed by the 2026 amendment ordinance [78], reportedly limited to critical sectors [79] (whether carried into the Act: to be confirmed)	DC0-first; DPIA before any DC2 work; DC3 excluded; no automated decisions about individuals; hosting in Bangladesh
National Data Management Act, 2026	Act No. 80 of 2026, gazetted on 10 April 2026, succeeding the National Data Management Ordinance, 2025 (called the National Data Governance Ordinance in some English reports) [6, 7, 9]. Deemed in force from 6 November 2025 [42]. Rules: to be confirmed	National Data Management Authority (s. 8); National Responsible Data Exchange (NRDEX); a chief data officer in every institution (s. 33); national code repository for government software (s. 23) [42]	Use NRDEX agreements where available; publish code openly; coordinate with the Authority and agency data officers
Cyber Security Act, 2026 and amendment	Act No. 81 of 2026, gazetted on 10 April 2026, deemed in force from 21 May 2025 [7, 10, 42]. Cyber Security (Amendment) Act, 2026 (Act No. 99), gazetted on 1 July 2026 with immediate effect, omits only section 20, the online gambling provision [11, 43]; it does not concern AI-generated content, contrary to an earlier report [102]. A further amendment under cabinet committee review from July 2026 was still proposed in September 2026 [44, 103]	National Cyber Security Agency (s. 5); critical information infrastructure; removal and blocking of content, subject to Tribunal approval within three days (s. 8); AI and AI-generated data named in the definitions (s. 2)	NIST CSF 2.0 controls; incident reporting; information-integrity research kept within law and rights
Right to Information Act, 2009	In force [74]	Proactive disclosure of public information	Supports the DC0 corpus and the public transparency register
National AI policy	Draft 2026-2030 released for public consultation in late January 2026 [12, 13]; revised draft (version 2.0, 9 February 2026) posted on the official portal [14]; formulation by a joint team announced to begin in Q4 2026 [16]. Not adopted	Risk categories; algorithmic impact assessment; an independent oversight committee to be created by an Act of Parliament; Bangla LLM; national compute; AI innovation fund of Tk 200 to 250 crore to 2030 (proposed) [12]	Tiers aligned to draft categories; Blueprint offered as technical input; BPFM coordinated with national LLM plans
Long-term national plans	Perspective Plan 2021 to 2041 (2020) and the draft ICT Master Plan 2041 [17, 18]	Long-term digital transformation goals	Roadmap aligned to the 2041 horizon and adaptable to plan revisions
AI Hub and AI skills project (KOICA, ICT Division, Bangladesh Hi-Tech Park Authority)	Technical assistance project proposal of Tk 192.66 crore awaiting government approval in June 2026 [56]; USD 13 million grant agreement (Record of Discussion) reported signed in August 2026 for 2026 to 2029 [58]. Not reported as operational	Skills, startups, AI adoption	Complementary division of labour; shared benchmarks and open data

Act numbers and Gazette dates are taken from the Legislative Division's list and from Gazette copies published by the ICT Division; provisions are summarised from the texts in the official laws database and from commentary, checked in October 2026. The Gazette copies could not be read in full by automated means (Annex P), so qualified Bangladesh counsel must confirm the provisions. This table is not legal advice.

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